

Lesson plan

Slide;

1. NA
2. Consider the statements and record opinion, feedback
3. Learning journey
4. Consider question, record opinion, feedback
5. Share information about politics and religion in the USA and UK, pose question and seek feedback
6. Share information
7. Share points in the history of politics and religion in the USA
8. Share information
9. Record 3 points of new learning, feedback
10. Set up main task, hand out case studies and answer questions in books, and feedback to teams.
11. Consider question, feedback
12. Share new information
13. Create and complete table, first with partner and then add to it as a gather and share
14. Possible answers
15. Return to lesson question

By the end of the lessons students need to know;

1. That religion plays an influential role in US politics including in speeches and campaigns
2. That religious groups campaign to influence political decisions
3. That the constitution states that the US government cannot create an official religion

How are religion and politics connected in the USA?



1. Religion should stay completely separate from politics

2. Politicians should be guided by their religious or non-religious beliefs

3. Religious groups should be allowed to campaign about laws

4. A country is better if its laws reflect religious views

Disagree

Agree

How far do you agree with each statement? Record on your whiteboard and explain your reasons.



Lesson question; How are religion and politics connected in the USA?

Topic question; Why don't all Christians express their religious tradition in the same way?

Unit 5 - Why don't all Christians express their religious tradition in the same way?

Core concepts



Belief



**Wisdom
and
authority**



Community

1. How diverse is Christianity in the USA?



1

2. What are the largest Christian groups in the USA?



2

4. What is the history and development of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter Day Saints?



4

6. Why is the Prosperity Gospel controversial?



6

3. What do fundamental Christians believe about creation?



3

5. What is the history and development of the Amish?



5

7. How are religion and politics connected in the USA? *



7

How are religion and politics connected in the USA?



Practice



Turned
Discussion

How connected do you think religion and politics are in the UK and the USA?

Give reasons to support your answer.

Not very

A little

Very



Lesson question; How are religion and politics connected in the USA?

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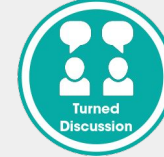
How are religion and politics connected in the USA?

USA



JESUS
IS MY SAVIOR
★ ★ ★ ★ ★
TRUMP
IS MY PRESIDENT

Do any of these surprise you?
Does this change your mind about how
connected religion and politics are in the UK
and the USA?



UK



Presidents swear
the oath on the
Bible

Campaigns
often talk
about religion

There are 26
Bishops in the
House of Lords



MPs choose to swear
the oath on a religious
text or make a
non-religious promise



Lesson question; How are religion and politics connected in the USA?

Topic question; Why don't all Christians express their religious tradition in the same way?



How are religion and politics connected in the USA?

Politics in the USA has a long and sometimes complicated history with religion, from the Founding Fathers to contemporary leaders like President Trump.

The First Amendment of the US Constitution states:

- “Congress shall make no law respecting an establishment of religion, or prohibiting the free exercise thereof.”

This means the government cannot create an official religion. But religion still influences politics.

Christianity is also a major influence:

- Around 63% of Americans identify as Christian (Pew Research, 2021).
- Many voters consider a politician's faith important.

Lesson question; How are religion and politics connected in the USA?

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How are religion and politics connected in the USA?

Faith and the Flag: A Timeline of Religion and Politics in the USA

While the U.S. government is legally secular, American politics has been inextricably linked to faith since its inception. This timeline tracks how the nation moved from integrated spiritual governance to a legal 'Wall of Separation,' and how religious movements continue to drive social change and political debate today.

FOUNDATIONS OF SPIRITUAL GOVERNANCE (PRE-1600S – 1791)



**INDIGENOUS
SPIRITUAL
LEADERSHIP**
(Pre-1600s)



**THE MAYFLOW
COMPACT**
(1620)



**THE 'WALL OF
SEPARATION'**
(1791)



**THE STRUGGLE
FOR INCLUSION**
(1830s)



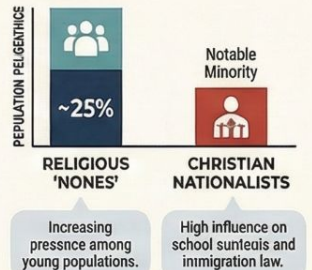
**FAITH AS AN ENGINE
FOR JUSTICE**
(1950s–60s)

FAITH IN ACTION AND MODERN SHIFTS (1830 – PRESENT)

THE 21ST CENTURY LANDSCAPE



CURRENT SHIFTS IN AMERICAN RELIGIOUS DEMOGRAPHICS



Lesson question; How are religion and politics connected in the USA?

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How are religion and politics connected in the USA?

Religion influences political debates on key issues:

- Abortion: Many Christian groups campaign for restrictions or freedoms.
- Same-sex marriage: Different churches have historically opposed or supported legal changes.
- Education: Debates about prayer in schools and teaching fundamental beliefs about creation.
- Charity: Many Christians advocate for social justice and helping the poor.

Politicians often reference God in speeches, and ceremonial practices like placing a hand on the Bible are common, though not required.



Lesson question; How are religion and politics connected in the USA?

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How are religion and politics connected in the USA?

What new knowledge of politics and religion in the USA do you have?

Record three points



Lesson question; How are religion and politics connected in the USA?

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How are religion and politics connected in the USA?

You're going to look at some different examples of topics which have cause debate and discussion in the USA to consider the relationship between religion and politics.

Each card has some information and 3 questions to answer. You should work through one with your partner and then feedback to your team.



Here are some quotes from the Bible which might help you with your answers;

- 'You shall not murder.'
- 'Do to others as you would have them do to you.'
- 'Speak up for those who cannot speak for themselves.'
- 'For I was hungry and you have me food, I was thirsty and you gave me drink, I was a stranger and you welcomed me.'
- 'Be fruitful multiply.'
- 'Before I formed you in the womb I knew you.'

Lesson question; How are religion and politics connected in the USA?

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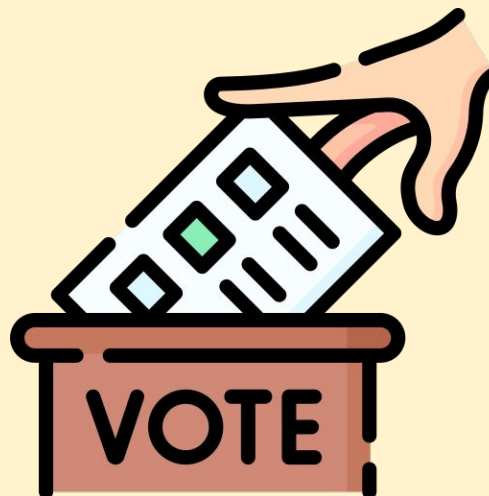
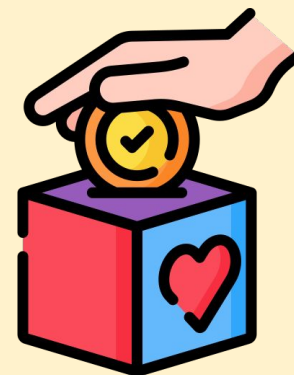
Practice



Speak For My Team

How are religion and politics connected in the USA?

Now you've had a look at some examples, do you think that religion and politics should be kept separate? Why?



Lesson question; How are religion and politics connected in the USA?

Topic question; Why don't all Christians express their religious tradition in the same way?



How are religion and politics connected in the USA?

Beyond the Basics

- **State vs Federal:** Laws vary across states; some allow moments of prayer in schools, others ban it. This shows how religion can influence politics locally even if federal law is neutral.
- **Political strategy:** Candidates often appeal to religious voters to gain support, using speeches, campaign promises, or attendance at churches.
- **Religious lobbying:** Christian organisations actively campaign on laws, e.g., restricting abortion, supporting charity programs, or influencing education policy.
- **Tension with the Constitution:** The law separates church and state, but religion still shapes voters' choices and politicians' priorities and campaigns.
- **Diverse Christian influence:** Different Christian groups push in opposite directions, creating debates and compromises in law-making.

Lesson question; How are religion and politics connected in the USA?

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Practice



Turned
Discussion

How are religion and politics connected in the USA?

**Religion should influence
politics**

**Religion should not
influence politics**

In your book create the table.

With your partner record two
reasons for each side, before you
Gather and Share to add more.



Gather &
Share



Lesson question; How are religion and politics connected in the USA?

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How are religion and politics connected in the USA?

Religion should influence politics	Religion should not influence politics

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Practice

How are religion and politics connected in the USA?



Let's return to the lesson question

How are religion and politics connected in the USA?

Include reasons for both sides of the debate, make sure you include reference to a key debate in your answer and also give your opinion about whether you think they should be connected or not.

Religion and politics are/are not connected in the USA, for example...



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